HOORVIA - SHAPE BUILDER TOOL: PRINTABLE ILLUSTRATOR GUIDE

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Tech & Software · Sheet #1

Action	How	Shortcut	Tip
Select shapes	Drag over overlapping shapes	V	Shapes must overlap
Activate Shape Builder	Click the tool in the toolbar	Shift+M	Or hold and drag
Merge shapes	Click or drag across areas	-	Dragging merges all touched areas
Subtract a shape	Hold Alt/Option and click	Alt+click	Removes the clicked area
Delete an area	Hold Alt/Option and drag	Alt+drag	Deletes the dragged area
Use Gap Detection	Turn it on in the tool options	-	Fills gaps between shapes
Set gap tolerance	Adjust in the options bar	-	Larger gaps need a higher value
Merge with stroke	Select shapes with strokes	-	Strokes merge into outlines
Create a compound path	Release after building	-	Keeps the shape editable
Undo a merge	Step back one action	Ctrl+Z	One step back at a time
Switch to Eraser mode	Alt/Option drag	-	Erases instead of merging
Exit the tool	Return to the Selection tool	V / Esc	Press V or Esc

PRO TIP: Shapes must overlap to merge: A hairline gap means the tool sees two shapes, not one. Zoom in and check the overlaps before you drag.